Q+A

PRINCESS DIARIES

Her first role in a Telugu film is **Janhvi Kapoor**'s ode to her mother Sridevi



Q. Is this the right time to venture into the film industry of the South?
I think it was destined. I have always wanted to work in the Telugu film industry. Bollywood films and those made in the South have always had this mutually nurturing relationship. With OTT platforms, the popularity of films made in southern languages has increased even more. I am lucky I got the perfect opportunity in *Devara*. Telugu cinema is where my mom started her career. I would consider myself blessed if I can get even a fraction of the love she received. I do hope this film and my work in it will make Amma happy!

Q. Do you believe you are emerging from the shadows of lineage?
I am so thankful for the opportunities I have got—with or without help for being who I am. Yes, sometimes, I find it difficult to look at things objectively because there are just so many opinions around me. The bottom line is I am happy doing my work! If I keep listening to the voices around me, I won't be able to focus on acting. I just pray I keep getting the kinds of films I have got so far and grow as an actor.

Q. Would you also want to venture beyond acting and get into production, which is your father's forte?
I have seen how Dad works—and he works very hard! There is a hell of a lot of work that goes into producing a film. I don't think I am experienced enough for that, yet. Acting is my focus at this stage in my career. The way I see it, acting could probably lead to it eventually.

Q. Besides *Devara*, what other projects are you working on?
There's lots of stuff from Dharma Productions—*Dostana 2* is something that fuels my vanity of dressing up pretty! I'm still keeping fingers crossed for *Takht*. Then there's *Mr. & Mrs. Mahi* with Rajkummar Rao. With cricket at its core, this one is really close to my heart. *Ulajh* will also hopefully be interesting and allow me to really push the envelope.

with Aarti Kapur Singh

Photograph by VAISHNAV PRAVEEN; *Styling by* PRANAY JAITLY *and* SHOUNAK AMONKAR
Hair: Mike Desir; Make-up: LEKHA GUPTA; *Outfit:* CORSET MIDI DRESS, VERSACE